

when they start suggesting various investment strategies and approaches to you.

Furthermore, being well-informed will help you avoid being taken advantage of if you do decide to outsource your money management. Perhaps an advisor recommends a subpar investment or charges too high a fee. If you're not educated about investing, you'll be less equipped to notice when something is amiss.

So, like I said earlier, knowing how investing works will help you make informed and confident decisions as an investor and will help you gain peace of mind about your money. Because at the end of the day, as easy and as simple as it might sound to hand everything investing-related off to an automated program or advisor or even avoid it altogether, you don't want to make guesses or blindly trust someone else with your hard-earned money.

WOMEN AND THE INVESTMENT GAP: WHY IT'S MORE IMPORTANT THAN EVER FOR WOMEN IN PARTICULAR TO INVEST

The statistics on women and investing are pretty depressing. First, there's the gender wage gap that we all talk about, which highlights the inequality issue of women earning 20% less on average than men. And when broken down by demographics, the stats are even more jarring. For every dollar earned by our white male counterparts, Asian women earn 87 cents, white women earn 82 cents, black women earn 65 cents, and Latina women earn 58 cents.

Keep in mind that this wage gap holds true despite our doing the same job functions and having similar work experience and educational backgrounds. Across demographics, the average woman is expected to earn \$430,480 less than the average white man over their lifetime.^{[1](#)} This is not okay.

On top of this, fewer women are investing their money. So, not only are we earning less; we are also not investing enough of the income we are getting. This means that in addition to the wage gap between women and men, there is also an investment gap, which has an even more severe impact on our